



Q

Why is it important to add bottled lemon juice or citric acid when canning tomatoes?



Adults

ANSWER

To ensure safe acidity levels preventing botulism

FUN FACT

Tomatoes are borderline acidic and need acid additions to be safely canned.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

What is the minimum headspace to leave when filling jars with hot salsa for canning?



Adults

ANSWER

1/2 inch

FUN FACT

Proper headspace prevents jar seal failure during processing.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

What is a risk of altering the acid amount in a tested salsa recipe before canning?



Adults

ANSWER

It can make the salsa unsafe and risk botulism

FUN FACT

Maintaining the tested acidity is critical for bacterial safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

Which type of vinegar is recommended for canning salsas as long as it has the correct acidity?



Adults

ANSWER

White vinegar with 5% acidity

FUN FACT

White vinegar won't discolor your salsa but is acidic enough for safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

When lemon or lime juice is called for in a salsa recipe, what is NOT a safe substitute?



Adults

ANSWER

Vinegar

FUN FACT

Vinegar is less acidic than lemon or lime juice and can't replace them safely.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

What happens if you add extra vegetables or fresh herbs not called for in salsa recipes before canning?



Adults

ANSWER

It may reduce acidity, causing unsafe conditions

FUN FACT

Do not add any extra fresh ingredients that can lower acidity.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Adults

Q

Why must you use only tomatoes from healthy, ripe vines for canning salsa?



Adults

ANSWER

Overripe or frost-damaged tomatoes can cause unsafe and poor-quality salsa

FUN FACT

Quality tomatoes ensure safe, tasty canned salsa.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

If a salsa recipe is not tested for canning safety, what is the recommended preservation method?



Adults

ANSWER

Freeze or refrigerate instead of canning

FUN FACT

Untested salsas may have unsafe acidity and must be frozen or refrigerated.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

For safe canning, how long should you process salsa in a boiling water canner at altitudes of 0-1,000 feet?



Adults

ANSWER

15 minutes

FUN FACT

Processing times increase with elevation to ensure safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

What type of tomatoes typically yields a thicker salsa when canned?



Adults

ANSWER

Paste tomatoes like Roma

FUN FACT

Paste tomatoes have firmer flesh that makes thicker salsas.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

What is a common method to remove tomato skins for salsa canning?



Adults

ANSWER

Dip tomatoes in boiling water for 30-60 seconds to split skins, then cool and peel

FUN FACT

Heating helps loosen tomato skins for easy removal.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

Which of the following is a true safety guideline for canning salsas?



Adults

ANSWER

Follow only research-tested recipes with correct acid levels

FUN FACT

Ignoring tested recipes can cause life-threatening foodborne illness.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

How should you treat jars and lids before filling them with hot salsa for canning?



Adults

ANSWER

Preheat jars in hot water and follow manufacturers' directions for lids

FUN FACT

Preheating helps prevent jar breakage during canning.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

What must you do after filling jars with salsa before processing to ensure safety?



Adults

ANSWER

Remove air bubbles and wipe jar rims clean

FUN FACT

Air bubbles can prevent sealing and lead to spoilage.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

Why is it important to use bottled lemon or lime juice instead of fresh for canning salsa?



Adults

ANSWER

Bottled juices have consistent acidity levels needed for safety

FUN FACT

Acidity can vary in fresh juice making it unsafe for canning.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

If you live above 6,000 feet altitude, how should you adjust boiling water canning times for salsa?



Adults

ANSWER

Increase processing time (e.g., to 25 minutes)

FUN FACT

Higher altitudes require longer processing for safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

During salsa preparation for canning, what is the purpose of simmering after boiling?



Adults

ANSWER

To thicken the salsa and develop flavors

FUN FACT

Simmering thickens salsa without overcooking.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



Q

What ingredient is essential in salsa recipes to prevent botulism growth during canning?



Adults

ANSWER

Acid like vinegar or bottled lemon/lime juice

FUN FACT

Acid keeps salsa safely acidic to prevent dangerous bacteria.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

Can original homemade salsa recipes be safely canned without testing?



Adults

ANSWER

No, untested salsa recipes should be frozen or refrigerated instead

FUN FACT

Only use tested salsa recipes for boiling water canning safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

What is a safe way to fix a prepared salsa after opening if it tastes too tart?



Adults

ANSWER

Add a small amount of sugar after opening

FUN FACT

Sugar after opening can balance acidity safely without affecting safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning